

Sometimes a Light Surprises

- 1 Sometimes a light surprises
the Christian while he sings;
it is the Lord, who rises
with healing in his wings:
when comforts are declining,
he grants the soul again
a season of clear shining,
to cheer it after rain.
- 2 In holy contemplation
we sweetly then pursue
the theme of God's salvation,
and find it ever new;
set free from present sorrow,
we cheerfully can say,
"Let the unknown tomorrow
bring with it what it may."
- 3 It can bring with it nothing
but he will bear us through;
who gives the lilies clothing
will clothe his people, too:
beneath the spreading heavens
no creature but is fed;
and he who feeds the ravens
will give his children bread.
- 4 Though vine, nor fig tree neither,
their wonted fruit shall bear,
though all the field should wither,
nor flocks, nor herds be there;
yet God the same abideth,
his praise shall tune my voice,
for, while in him confiding,
I cannot but rejoice.

Words: William Cowper, 1779

Music: John Hullah, 1867

Tune: BENTLEY · 7.6.7.6.D · Scripture: Malachi 4:2

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